

Template: a visual guide to research posters

Your name Your collaborator

Your research team — Your university or organisation

Conference name and date

1. Start here: one file, one poster

This poster is the tutorial. Read down the left column, then the right. Every example is editable in `poster.tex`.

- Find a layout here and search for its block title in the source.
- Copy the complete `colorblock`; replace its content.
- Replace the header and remove the guide blocks you do not need.

Build locally: run `make poster` and open `poster.pdf`. In VS Code, choose **Build poster** under **Terminal > Run Build Task**.

Overleaf: select `poster.tex` as the main document and pdfLaTeX as the compiler. Keep the shared style, poster theme, and your assets alongside the source.

2. Choose the size and edit the header

At the top of the file, change only `size=a0` to `size=a1` for the smaller format. Keep the same content, two columns, and `scale=1.2`.

```
\usepackage[orientation=portrait,
  size=a0,scale=1.2]{beamerposter}
```

A0: 841 × 1189 mm (default). **A1:** 594 × 841 mm. Fonts and spacing scale with the page. Print at actual size (100%).

```
\title{Your research title}
\author{Alex Lee \and Sam Chen}
\institute{Your team or organisation}
\date{Conference name and date}
```

The theme prints this header automatically. Titles wrap naturally; use `\\` for a deliberate line break. Replace the logo paths in `\titlegraphic` with PNG, JPG, or PDF files. Missing logos are skipped; remove that entire command to omit the logo row.

3. Arrange two columns

One frame contains the whole poster. Keep `[fragile,t]` on the frame when showing literal code. The two equal column widths and the central gap come from the theme.

```
\begin{columns}[T,onlytextwidth]
  \begin{column}{\templatePosterColumnWidth}
    Your left-column blocks.
  \end{column}
  \hfill
  \begin{column}{\templatePosterColumnWidth}
    Your right-column blocks.
  \end{column}
\end{columns}
```

Copy blocks within either column. Between them, keep `\vspace{\templatePosterBlockGap}` for consistent spacing. Shorten overflowing content before reducing the font size.

4. Use colour to explain the research

Every block uses the same layout; its optional colour communicates its purpose. Omit the colour for the burgundy default.

```
\begin{colorblock}[orange]{Research gap}
  Describe what is missing.
\end{colorblock}
```

- orange Problems and research gaps
- darkblue Research questions and goals
- turquoise Solutions and answers
- burgundy Highlights and conclusions

5. Add figures and captions

Use a placeholder while preparing a figure. Its height is a fraction of the current column width, so it scales with the poster.



```
\begin{figure}
  \figureplaceholder[0.22\linewidth]
  {Your research figure}
  \caption{Explain the main result.}
\end{figure}
```

For a real figure, replace only the placeholder command:

```
\includegraphics[width=\linewidth]
{assets/your-figure.pdf}
```

Keep the figure and `\caption`. Use vector PDFs or high-resolution PNG/JPG images for printing.

6. Present a compact results table

The shared style includes booktabs. Replace these illustrative values, and label your units explicitly.

Method	Score
Baseline	0.72
Proposed	0.86

```
\begin{tabular}{@{}lr@{}}
  \toprule
  \textbf{Method} & \textbf{Score} \\
  \midrule
  Baseline & 0.72 \\
  Proposed & 0.86 \\
  \bottomrule
\end{tabular}
```

Illustrative data only. Add the source of your actual results here.

7. Finish with a takeaway and a source

State the one finding you want your reader to remember.

Author(s), title, venue, year. Reference placeholder.

```
\takeaway{Your main finding.}
\source{Author(s), title, venue, year.}
```

Use a short reference, acknowledgement, or contact line with `\source`. No bibliography processor is needed. For a large value with a label, use `\metric{86\%}{Example score}`.

8. Make the template your own

Content: edit `poster.tex`.
Shared style: edit `beamerCommon.sty` for colours, fonts, and helpers used by both slides and posters.
Poster layout: edit `beamerthemeTemplatePoster.sty` for the header, margins, padding, and column spacing.
The poster theme starts with the editable lengths: `\templatePosterMargin`, `\templatePosterGap`, `\templatePosterBlockGap`, and `\templatePosterBlockPadding`. Equal column widths are calculated from those settings.

Before sharing: replace the guide text and example values, check the PDF at your chosen size, and confirm everything fits on one page. See `slides.tex` for more shared examples, including highlighted code with line numbers.